Problem-Solution Fit

Phase 3: Project Design Phase

1. Problem Fit

The project addresses the early planning stage of travel, where a user has preferences and constraints but needs help arranging them into a schedule and checking that it fits the budget. The strongest fit is a planning assistant that produces an editable draft quickly, not an end-to-end travel marketplace.

2. Proposed Value

A five-step wizard collects the inputs. The AI service uses them to produce a day-wise plan, estimated costs, accommodation suggestions and transit tips. The budget summary shows whether the plan fits. The user can edit, regenerate a day, save the trip and print it. A demo mode lets anyone try the full flow without keys or an account.

3. Feature-to-Need Relationship

Personalization

The prompt uses destination, dates, traveller type and count, budget and currency, style, pace, interests, accommodation preference, dietary and accessibility needs and notes. These inputs let the model tailor the plan, although they do not guarantee that every recommendation is feasible or accurate.

Budget control

The budget service separates lodging, food, activities and transit and compares the total with the target. This answers the question travellers ask first: can we afford this plan?

Adjustability

Inline editing, deletion and day regeneration recognize that a generated draft is a starting point. Costs are recalculated after changes.

Continuity and portability

Saved Trips, search and filters allow returning to earlier plans, and the print stylesheet makes a plan portable.

4. Fit Boundaries

The project does not handle bookings, payments, real-time availability or guaranteed prices. The model can produce plausible but inaccurate facts. The day-regeneration routine in the current code produces refreshed alternative entries by transforming the existing activities; it is not a new model call. These boundaries should be stated during a demonstration.

5. Validation Plan

- Ask representative users to plan a realistic trip with the wizard.
- Observe whether the five steps are understood without help.
- Check whether the budget summary and warnings are easy to interpret.
- Test saving, reopening, editing, filtering and deleting a trip.
- Ask whether estimates and demo-mode behaviour are clearly communicated.
- Record issues and improve the interface from observed evidence.

6. Conclusion

The implementation fits a prototype for personalized, budget-aware itinerary drafting. Stronger claims about user satisfaction or time saved require a real evaluation.